

# World of Darkness — GM Theme Cheat Sheet

One-glance reference for tone and table mood. Excludes Demon, Mummy & Wraith.

## Classic vs. Chronicles — sibling lines

| Concept      | Classic (oWoD)        | Chronicles (CofD)                        |
|--------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Vampires     | The Masquerade ★★★★★  | The Requiem ★★★½                         |
| Werewolves   | The Apocalypse ★★★★★½ | The Forsaken ★★★                         |
| Mages        | The Ascension ★★★★★   | The Awakening ★★★½                       |
| Hunters      | The Reckoning ★★★★★   | The Vigil ★★★                            |
| Changelings  | The Dreaming ★★★★★½   | The Lost ★★★                             |
| Death/ghosts | (Wraith — excluded)   | Geist: Sin-Eaters ★★½                    |
| No oWoD twin | —                     | Promethean ★★★ · Beast ★★½ · Deviant ★★½ |

## Core emotional engine of each line

| Line                            | The question it asks                             |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Vampire: The Masquerade</b>  | How much of your soul will you trade for power?  |
| <b>Werewolf: The Apocalypse</b> | How do you fight well in a war you can't win?    |
| <b>Mage: The Ascension</b>      | If belief makes reality, what is truth?          |
| <b>Hunter: The Reckoning</b>    | When does the monster-hunter become the monster? |
| <b>Vampire: The Requiem</b>     | What does eternity cost a conscience?            |
| <b>Mage: The Awakening</b>      | Is enlightenment worth the fall it demands?      |
| <b>Changeling: The Dreaming</b> | Can wonder survive a world that mocks it?        |
| <b>Changeling: The Lost</b>     | How do you reclaim a life that was stolen?       |
| <b>Werewolf: The Forsaken</b>   | What will you do to hold your territory?         |
| <b>Hunter: The Vigil</b>        | What does knowing the truth cost you?            |
| <b>Promethean: The Created</b>  | What actually makes a person human?              |
| <b>Geist: The Sin-Eaters</b>    | What debts do the dead leave the living?         |
| <b>Beast: The Primordial</b>    | What if you ARE the thing in the dark?           |
| <b>Deviant: The Renegades</b>   | Is revenge worth what it makes of you?           |

## Tone dial — set the table mood

- **Gothic politics & seduction** → Vampire (Masquerade / Requiem)
- **Rage, action, eco-horror** → Werewolf (Apocalypse / Forsaken)
- **Cerebral, philosophical, weird** → Mage (Ascension / Awakening)
- **Grounded paranoia & desperation** → Hunter (Reckoning / Vigil)
- **Bittersweet wonder** → Changeling: The Dreaming
- **Captivity & trauma horror** → Changeling: The Lost
- **Quiet tragedy & longing** → Promethean
- **Death, debts & the underworld** → Geist
- **Self-justifying predation** → Beast
- **Vengeance thriller / body horror** → Deviant

**Mixing lines?** *Classic and Chronicles cosmologies don't share rules or metaphysics — pick one universe per chronicle. Within a universe, cross-line play (e.g., Vampire + Werewolf + Mage) is supported but raises power-balance and tone-clash issues. Decide the dominant mood first, then invite the others into it.*